Rizq Khairulnizam

rizqkhairulnizam@gmail.com • +60 11-3732 8842 • rizqkhairulnizam.github.io • linkedin.com/in/rizqkhairulnizam

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University | Majlis Amanah Rakyat (MARA) YTP Scholar — **University Park, USA**
Cybersecurity Analytics and Operations, B.S. — *Graduated: May 2026*
Security and Risk Analysis, Minor — *CGPA: 3.90/4.00*
Information Sciences and Technology, Minor — *Honors: Cum Laude*
National Security Agency, Certificate — *Dean's List: 8/8 Semesters*

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATION

CompTIA Network+ (N10-009) — *June 2026 – June 2029*
ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) — *August 2024 – July 2027*

WORK EXPERIENCE

The Pennsylvania State University, College of Information Sciences and Technology — **University Park, USA**
Learning Assistant for SRA365 (R) and SRA211 (Terrorism and Crime) — *January 2026 – May 2026*
Learning Assistant for IST210 (MySQL) and SRA231 (Decision Theory and Analysis) — *August 2024 – December 2025*

CyberSecurity Malaysia, MyCERT — **Cyberjaya, Malaysia**
Security Analyst Intern — *June 2025 – August 2025*

- Competed in the international Standoff Cyberbattle for SPIEF 2025 as part of "Pasukan Biru," representing Malaysia against international teams, ranked 4th out of 12, and resolved 1/7 cases by performing a complete kill chain and an incident investigation.
- Gained hands-on experience with physical penetration testing tools and configured a custom attack device for wireless exploitation.
- Developed 3 Red Team documentation including Rules of Engagement (RoE), Letter of Authorization (LoA), and legal guidelines.
- Developed and delivered comprehensive training sessions to department staff on 11 red team exercise types, social engineering tactics, and non-verbal communication cues to strengthen security awareness, espionage prevention, and insider threat detection.

Nexagate, Managed Security Department — **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia**
Managed Security Intern — *May 2024 – August 2024*

- Developed a dashboard that visualizes user account movement across networks using Sankey diagrams to track lateral movements.
- Conducted Incident Response (IR) using Splunk SIEM to triage alerts, reduce false positives, and notify affected clients.
- Analyzed threat reports, mapped TTPs to MITRE ATT&CK and extracted IoCs to produce weekly client-facing threat intelligence.
- Monitored logs and produced weekly reports on the traffic status and condition of 5 client domains with Imperva WAF.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

JURUS Secure Healthcare System Deployment — **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia**
Individual — *May 2026 – July 2026*

- Designed and deployed a secure healthcare system on AWS EC2 Ubuntu instance using Docker, OpenEMR, MariaDB, and Nginx.
- Hardened the infrastructure with HTTPS/TLS, SSH conf, UFW, Fail2Ban, security headers, and least-privilege database access.
- Secured OpenEMR with MFA, RBAC and implemented centralized monitoring using Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, and Promtail.
- Automated database and docker compose backups using Bash, Cron, AWS S3 and presented complete architecture to 2 panelists.

Abnormal Traffic Dashboard on Splunk SIEM — **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia**
Team Member — *June 2024 – August 2024*

- Designed and developed an analytical Splunk dashboard aimed to assist 10 SOC Security Analysts in monitoring activity, recording abnormally high or low log count, and calculating future projections of 5 firewall hosts.
- Scripted 3 complex SPL queries to gain targeted graphs and visuals of traffic deviations using the standard deviation of the dataset.
- Scripted 2 complex SPL queries to track the all-time-high record for 1 firewall host and export the record into a lookup table.

SKILLS

Technical: Linux, Bash, R, SQL (MySQL and MariaDB), Splunk SPL, Cron, AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, Security Groups), Docker, Nginx
Offensive: Red Team Operations Planning, Social Engineering, Offensive Security Governance, Wireless Penetration Testing
Defensive: Malware Analysis, Threat Intelligence, Security Hardening, Network Security, Incident Response, Business Continuity
Security Tools: Splunk SIEM, Elastic SIEM, Imperva WAF, OpenCTI, UFW, Fail2Ban, Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, Promtail
Languages: Malay (Native), English (Bilingual), Japanese (N5)

HONORS & AWARDS

JURUS Level 1 – ANALYST (Rank: 4th / 30) — **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia**
RawSEC & Cybersecurity Research Centre (CYRES), Universiti Sains Malaysia (USM) — *June 2026*

- Awarded the ANALYST badge and certificate after passing a comprehensive six-domain cybersecurity engineering assessment.

Certificate of Academic Excellence — **University Park, USA**
Majlis Amanah Rakyat (MARA) — *December 2025*

- Awarded a Certificate of Academic Excellence for achieving a 4.00 GPA and maintaining a CGPA above 3.50 in Spring 2025.